Graduate School Operations Manual: summary, the group's answers, and sign-off

Companion to: USLS GS Operations Manual - DRAFT for Validation, version 0.2 (113 pages), as submitted. The manual itself is not changed by this document. Prepared by Capstone group CAP-IT1, 4 November 2026.

What this document is for

The defense panel asked the group to have the Operations Manual approved by the Graduate School. Chapter 6 of the manual lists 50 open questions. To save the office's time, the group has answered all 50 itself, following the Graduate Programs Student Handbook 2022-2023 wherever it is clear, and otherwise what the platform already does. The Graduate School does not need to answer anything: only to review and sign.

What the manual covers

Part of the manual	What is in it
Chapters 1 to 3	Purpose and scope; who does what (roles); which office keeps which record.
Chapter 4 (24 sections)	Each process of a graduate student, from admission to graduation: enrollment, course offering, withdrawal, dropping, leave of absence, readmission, AWOL, residency, comprehensive examination, title, proposal and final defense, adviser, revisions, defense scheduling, practicum, graduation, Registrar handoff, teaching load, accounts, e-approval, data privacy, AIMS data. Each section gives the steps, the rules, the forms, and what the platform does.
Chapter 5	All business rules in one list, each with its source (Handbook, Protocol, office practice, or proposed by the group).
Chapter 6	50 open questions. Answered by the group on pages 2 and 3 of this document.
Chapter 7, Appendices	Sign-off and change log; forms crosswalk (Appendix A); glossary (Appendix B).

How to review it (about 30 minutes)

- Read pages 2 and 3 of this document: the group's answer to each open question.
- Optional: open the manual only at the Chapter 4 sections your office handles.
- Write any correction on this document or e-mail it to the group within 7 days.
- Sign page 4. Answers with no correction stand.

The group's answers to the 50 open questions (manual Chapter 6)

Basis: Handbook = Graduate Programs Student Handbook 2022-2023; Protocol = Research Protocol AY 2024-2025; Platform = what the platform does now; Proposed = the group's proposal where both are silent; Office = the Graduate School or another office supplies the detail (the platform shows it as "to be confirmed by the office" until then).

No.	Topic	The group's answer	Basis
OQ-01	Withdrawal of subject: window and fee	Until the end of the second week; 10% of fees in week 1, 20% in week 2.	Handbook
OQ-02	Withdrawal before classes start: cost	Accepted; no amount shown; the Business Office confirms any charge.	Office
OQ-03	Single subject after week 2	Not allowed; the student files a leave of absence or withdraws all subjects.	Platform
OQ-04	Approval of withdrawal and drop	The Dean approves or denies every withdrawal (a denial needs a reason); a drop needs no approval.	Platform
OQ-05	Drop procedure	Arranged with the Academic Coordinator, no form; the Coordinator records it.	Platform
OQ-06	DRP grade and dismissal	The Dean decides case by case; the platform does not dismiss a student on its own.	Platform
OQ-07	Add or change after week 1	Only as a documented exception with the Associate Dean's written approval.	Platform
OQ-08	How weeks are counted	Calendar days from the official first day of classes of the semester.	Handbook
OQ-09	Length of a leave of absence	One year, renewable once; no limit on the number of leaves.	Handbook
OQ-10	Leave and maximum residence	Time on leave counts toward maximum residence.	Handbook
OQ-11	Leave filing deadline	A leave may start during the semester until two weeks before the last day of classes.	Handbook
OQ-12	Letter or form	The platform form counts as the written request; a pending request may be withdrawn.	Platform
OQ-13	Readmission requirements	Both the Handbook's and the platform's lists; the Academic Coordinator interviews; the Dean's Advise Slip clears enrollment.	Handbook + Platform
OQ-14	AWOL	After one semester with no enrollment and no approved leave; counts toward maximum residence.	Platform
OQ-15	Residency enrollment	As for a regular semester; no limit other than maximum residence. Fee from the Business Office.	Proposed / Office
OQ-16	Maximum residence count and extension	Counted from first enrollment; the Academic Coordinator recommends, the Dean approves an extension.	Platform
OQ-17	Comprehensive exam order	Passed before the title defense and the adviser; the office can switch this check off.	Handbook p. 57
OQ-18	Missed comprehensive exam	Fee forfeited, re-enroll in residency; the Dean evaluates doctorate students.	Proposed
OQ-19	Who approves the adviser	The Dean, Associate Dean and Research Coordinator together; the program adviser is consulted.	Protocol
OQ-20	Adviser eligibility and limit	As in the Research Protocol: five active advisees per academic year.	Protocol
OQ-21	Adviser nomination	Form 3 names one adviser who has already agreed; no three-nominee step.	Protocol
OQ-22	External panel member approval	The GS Research Committee.	Protocol
OQ-23	Public final defense notice	Posted 5 days before; the panel has the manuscript 14 days before.	Handbook + Protocol
OQ-24	Public defense time	30 minutes presentation, 30 minutes questions.	Proposed
OQ-25	Publication for graduation	Required for students enrolled from AY 2022-2023 (Scopus/ISI/WoS for PhD, peer-reviewed for MA); earlier students present at a conference.	Handbook p. 77
OQ-26	Time to send completion documents	By the graduation review window.	Proposed
OQ-27	Defense fees and honoraria	Amounts set by the Graduate School and Business Office; the platform records no amounts.	Office
OQ-28	Rescheduling a defense	The Research Coordinator, with a recorded reason, keeping the lead time.	Platform
OQ-29	Practicum	Psychology programs and MSGC, 200 hours each, as in the platform; other programs on request.	Platform
OQ-30	Graduation review window	A fixed window each semester; dates set by the office.	Office
OQ-31	Graduation document checklist	The Handbook's completion list for every program.	Handbook
OQ-32	Registrar acknowledgement and formats	Acknowledgement kept outside the platform; file formats as the Registrar requests.	Office
OQ-33	Who imports the monitoring workbook	The Academic Coordinator, each term.	Platform
OQ-34	Minimum class size	One student counts as a need; the Academic Coordinator decides; a small class is a special class.	Platform
OQ-35	Approval of the offering	The Academic Coordinator decides the offering; the Dean is informed.	Platform
OQ-36	Failures and incompletes	Faculty e-mail them to the Academic Coordinator.	Proposed
OQ-37	Seminar series and research conference	Two separate requirements.	Handbook

No.	Topic	The group's answer	Basis
OQ-38	Handbook in force	The Handbook 2022-2023 is in force; any later memo replaces the rule it covers.	Handbook
OQ-39	Office names and mailboxes	As in the Research Protocol (the newer source).	Protocol
OQ-40	Closed-door or public defense track	Decided by the date of admission (before August 2020: no public defense).	Handbook
OQ-41	Research time limit exceeded	The Dean may extend once.	Proposed
OQ-42	External member on a project paper panel	No.	Handbook + Protocol
OQ-43	Waiver of the two-week rule	The Dean may waive it for a stated reason (recorded in the platform).	Platform
OQ-44	Course prerequisites	None, unless a program's curriculum lists them.	Handbook
OQ-45	Teaching load	At most 24 units, same college only; the Dean approves the offering plan.	Platform
OQ-46	Platform accounts	The Dean approves staff and coordinator accounts; the University names the Dean's account.	Proposed
OQ-47	Platform approval as signature	Accepted for all forms except where the Research Protocol requires an e-signature on the form.	Proposed
OQ-48	Data privacy	The University's Data Protection Officer; consent at first sign-in; the outside AI service stays off.	Proposed
OQ-49	Records retention	5 years; the graduation list and transmittals kept permanently; the Dean approves disposal.	Proposed
OQ-50	AIMS export	Not used yet; the Academic Coordinator's monitoring workbook stays the only input.	Platform

Sign-off

By signing, the reviewer approves the University of St. La Salle Graduate School Operations Manual, draft version 0.2, as the working manual of the platform for user acceptance testing, with the group's answers in this document. Corrections may be sent to the group within 7 days of signing; an answer with no correction by then stands. Details marked Office stay open until the office supplies them. The group will enter all corrections in the next version of the manual and record them in its change log (Chapter 7.2).

Name	Position	Signature	Date
	Graduate School Dean		
	Associate Dean		

Corrections (optional)

No. (OQ-nn) or manual section	Correction